

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	726
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	05/2018
		Review Date:	01/2028

ALLERGIC REACTION AND ANAPHYLAXIS / SHOCK	
Allergic Reaction – Hives, rash, and swelling to site with normal vital signs and a local reaction to an allergen Anaphylaxis – A systemic response to an allergen involving 2 or more organ systems or any deterioration of vital signs	
ADULT	PEDIATRIC
BLS	
Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO ₂ / Oxygen. Titrate to SpO ₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations, if needed. Patient's Medication – Assist the patient with Albuterol/Ventolin MDI, if available and if indicated.	
Allergic Reaction	
If patient can swallow: Diphenhydramine – 50 mg PO Single dose	If the patient can swallow: Diphenhydramine < 25 kg, 12.5 mg PO ≥ 25 kg, 25 mg PO - Single dose
Anaphylaxis (EMT – Optional Scope)	
Epinephrine Auto-Injector – 0.3 mg IM from an EpiPen® (or equivalent) or an approved epinephrine injector kit - May repeat after 5-10 minutes if no improvement - Maximum of 3 doses	Epinephrine Auto-Injector – 0.15 mg IM from an EpiPen® (or equivalent) or an approved epinephrine injector kit - May repeat after 5-10 minutes if no improvement - Maximum of 3 doses
If patient can swallow: Diphenhydramine – 50 mg PO Single dose	If the patient can swallow: Diphenhydramine < 25 kg, 12.5 mg PO ≥ 25 kg, 25 mg PO - Single dose

Signatures on File

Approved By: Tim Williams
EMS Administrator

Ajinder Singh, MD
EMS Medical Director

ALS

Follow BLS procedures if applicable.

Obtain 4-Lead EKG.

Vascular Access – IV/IO rate as appropriate (Two (2) large bore IVs for Anaphylaxis)

Allergic Reaction

Diphenhydramine – 25 mg IV/IM OR 50 mg PO if the patient can swallow

- Single dose

Diphenhydramine – 1 mg/kg IV/IM OR PO if the patient can swallow – PO refer to BLS policy above

- Max dose 25 mg
- Single dose

Anaphylaxis

Epinephrine 1:1,000 – 0.01 mg/kg IM, max dose 0.5 mg

- May repeat after 3-5 minutes if no improvement
- Consider using IV epinephrine after a second dose if no improvement

Epinephrine 1:1,000 – 0.01 mg/kg IM max dose 0.3 mg

- May repeat after 3-5 minutes if no improvement
- Consider using IV epinephrine after second dose if no improvement

Diphenhydramine – 50 mg IV/IO/IM

- Single dose

Diphenhydramine – 1 mg/kg IV/IO/IM, max dose 50 mg

- Single dose

Albuterol – 5.0 mg via nebulizer for respiratory distress with wheezing or diminished lung sounds

- Repeat as necessary

If SBP < 90 mmHg and/or the patient has severe respiratory distress:

Epinephrine 1:10,000 – 0.1 mg (1 mL) slow IVP

- May repeat every 2-3 minutes to SBP > 90 mmHg or a decrease in respiratory effort

Base Hospital Physician Orders Only

For hypotension per length-based assessment tape or application and severe respiratory distress:

Epinephrine 1:10,000 – 0.01 mg/kg slow IV/IO, max dose 0.1 mg (1 mL)

- May repeat every 2-3 minutes until hypotension resolves or respiratory effort decreases